line. He was the most charming and devil-may-care spy of our time.'

That April night when the band of three sat down to discuss the plan, the first thing they agreed was not to travel together. They would work alone and a pre-decided monthly meeting would be held at the Wisdom Road safe house. Sanjiv Sahgal was put in charge of PSY-OPS (Psychological Operations), while Kailash Singh was handed the task of infiltrating the camps of Rabuka's opponents to ensure that the agitation against military rule continued with maximum efficiency. Malik was to supervise the entire operation besides helping the opposition in Fiji with finances and weapons if required. This was an exclusive operation. The band had clear instructions not to contact R&AW operatives working undercover in Australia and New Zealand.

Within a few days Sahgal activated his contacts in the media. The main task was to run a series of campaigns in Australia, New Zealand and the UK in support of democracy in Fiji. The long term strategy was to create international pressure to end military rule and hold general elections under the supervision of neutral countries. Sahgal quickly recruited local assets and paid them huge sums to gain space in influential publications. In the meantime, Kailash went to Wellington for a meeting with Benjamin Taylor, the owner of an electronics equipment company set up in the late 1970s and a man truly entrenched in his country's political system. Kailash's purpose, Shekhawat recalled, was clear: 'Generate support from New Zealand politicians for the deposed Bavadra government and hire those having even the slightest link with Fiji politicians. He was required to identify vulnerable politicians and Taylor was the man best suited to help.'